

The Rehearsal Arc

A facilitator's workbook

Paracosm · Trainings · Retreats · Residencies

How to use this workbook

Each of the nine offerings is scored through the same two coordinates: the five cognitive states — LOVE, MAGIC, CALM, OPEN, FREE — and the three simultaneous journeys — Narrative, Cognitive, Identity.

Read the offering that fits the room you are in. Use the exercises verbatim the first time. Rewrite them the second time. By the third time they belong to your practice.

Voice in this workbook is facilitator's voice: second-person, timed, ready to read aloud.

The ontology

The five states

Love — Why this matters

Intent — Anchor emotional resonance and the meaningful future.

Facilitator move — Open a door — never a slide deck.

Magic — The reframe

Intent — Surprise the pattern. Break the default lens.

Facilitator move — Show the thing they didn't know was there.

Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce the framework. Reduce uncertainty.

Facilitator move — Draw the map slowly. Name each region once.

Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Interactive exercise. Reflection made legible.

Facilitator move — Get out of the way. Notice, don't teach.

Free — Commitment

Intent — Clear next step. One thing to try on Monday.

Facilitator move — Ask for the smallest brave promise.

The three journeys

Narrative

What is the story people will tell tomorrow?

Artefact — A quotable line.

Cognitive

What is the model they now hold in their hands?

Artefact — A diagram they can redraw from memory.

Identity

Who do they now see themselves becoming?

Artefact — A first-person sentence starting with 'I am someone who...'

GL!TCH — Clarity Reset

Foreplay · Trainings · 65 hours over 8 weeks

The official 65-hour Crewdle AI Formation. Rehearse the reframe until the team can do it without you in the room.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You walked in with a stack of AI tools and no clarity. You walk out with one shared reframe of what the org is actually being asked to become.

Cognitive — The 5-state Calm Magic ontology applied to AI adoption. Every meeting becomes a legible arc from resonance to commitment.

Identity — From tool-picker to intention-designer. You stop asking 'which AI?' and start asking 'which future?'

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Anchor why this shift matters before any tool is named.

Prompt: "What are you afraid AI will take from you — and what are you afraid it will ask of you?"

Artifact — A wall of postcards representing the room's 3-year horizon.

Exercise 1: The Two Fears (15 min)

Intent — Surface the loss AND the demand.

"Write two sentences on one card: 'I'm afraid AI will take ____' and 'I'm afraid AI will ask me to ____'."

Materials — Index cards, one felt pen per person.

Debrief — Read only the second sentence around the circle. No commentary. Let the silence do the work.

Exercise 2: Meaningful Future Postcard (20 min)

Intent — Move from fear to a concrete 3-year image.

"Draw or describe the day-in-the-life of your role three years from now if this shift went well."

Materials — Blank postcards, colored markers.

Debrief — Pair-share for 5 minutes. Ask: 'What surprised you about your own postcard?'

Exercise 3: The Resonance Line (10 min)

Intent — Physically map how the team relates to the shift.

"Stand on a line from 'this excites me' to 'this exhausts me'. Move once someone else speaks."

Materials — Masking tape line on the floor.

Debrief — Notice who moved and when. Ask: 'What did you hear that moved you?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I was allowed to name what I was afraid of.
- Cognitive — The model: emotion is data, not noise before the real work.
- Identity — I am someone whose fear can be spoken and stay welcome.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — Break the default lens: AI adoption is not tool selection.

Prompt: "What if the AI isn't the product — what if the reframe is?"

Artifact — One workflow redrawn twice — with tools, then without. Kept side by side.

Exercise 1: Tool-Free Fridge Test (25 min)

Intent — Prove the reframe by forbidding tools.

"Redesign one broken workflow without naming a single tool. Only verbs and outcomes."

Materials — Whiteboard, sticky notes with only verbs written.

Debrief — Compare with the group's tool-first draft. Ask: 'What did removing tools reveal?'

Exercise 2: Reverse Demo (15 min)

Intent — Show the future by demoing the failure it prevents.

"In pairs, act out the meeting this workflow will replace. Play it straight."

Materials — None.

Debrief — Debrief: 'What did the old meeting cost us that we had normalized?'

Exercise 3: The Ontology Swap (20 min)

Intent — Introduce Calm Magic states as the new lens.

"Re-tell one recent project through LOVE → MAGIC → CALM → OPEN → FREE, one sentence per state."

Materials — The 5-state cheat card (provided).

Debrief — Ask: 'Which state was under-invested? Which was skipped entirely?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day we stopped naming tools.
- Cognitive — The model: verbs before nouns. States before stacks.
- Identity — I am someone who leads with intention before selection.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce the framework with enough rigor to be trusted.

Prompt: "Where is the uncertainty actually living in this org?"

Artifact — A 2x2 of live decisions and a wall of imperfect memory-drawn frameworks.

Exercise 1: The Uncertainty Map (25 min)

Intent — Locate the fog before choosing the flashlight.

"Plot every open decision on a 2x2: reversible/irreversible × known/unknown."

Materials — Large printed 2x2, dot stickers.

Debrief — Focus on the irreversible-unknown quadrant. Ask: 'Which of these should NOT be decided this quarter?'

Exercise 2: Five Seasons Walkthrough (30 min)

Intent — Teach the PRD ontology (POLLENS → ANTHEMS) with a live case.

"Take one initiative and place it in each season. Note what's missing."

Materials — Five-season poster, markers.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which season did we jump over? What did that cost?'

Exercise 3: The Legibility Test (10 min)

Intent — Framework only helps if someone can redraw it from memory.

"Close the poster. Redraw the 5 seasons and 5 states from memory on a napkin."

Materials — Napkin per person, pen.

Debrief — Post the napkins on the wall. Nobody's is perfect — that's the point.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day the fog got a map.
- Cognitive — The model: 5 seasons × 5 states = 25 places to look.
- Identity — I am someone who can name where uncertainty lives.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Discovery through interaction — the room becomes the teacher.

Prompt: "What pattern is repeating that nobody has named yet?"

Artifact — The named clusters and the list of missing voices.

Exercise 1: Silent Wall (20 min)

Intent — Let patterns emerge without a facilitator's voice.

"In silence, cluster all week's sticky notes. Only movement, no talking."

Materials — Every sticky from the week, one blank wall.

Debrief — Only after silence ends: 'What cluster names itself?'

Exercise 2: The Missing Voice (15 min)

Intent — Notice which stakeholder never gets quoted.

"List every role mentioned this week. Circle the ones nobody quoted verbatim."

Materials — Flipchart, colored circles.

Debrief — Ask: 'Who has to be in the room next week?'

Exercise 3: Reflection Triads (30 min)

Intent — Turn insight into shareable language.

"In triads: speaker (5 min uninterrupted) → mirror (2 min reflect back) → scribe (2 min write it down)."

Materials — Timer, notebook.

Debrief — Read the scribed lines aloud. Which ones want to become the team's next question?

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the silence when we finally saw the pattern.
- Cognitive — The model: patterns emerge from arrangement, not argument.
- Identity — I am someone who can hold a room in productive silence.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — One clear commitment per person. No more.

Prompt: "What is the smallest brave thing you will do by Monday?"

Artifact — A bowl of commitment stones. A shared spreadsheet of Monday actions.

Exercise 1: Smallest Brave Promise (10 min)

Intent — Force scoping down to a real action.

"One sentence: 'By Monday I will _____. My witness is _____.'"

Materials — Promise cards.

Debrief — Read all cards aloud. Nothing else needs to be said.

Exercise 2: The 30-Day Undo Clause (10 min)

Intent — Make commitment feel safe by making retreat legible.

"Add a sentence: 'If by day 30 ____ is true, I will stop and re-open the question.'"

Materials — Same card.

Debrief — Notice how commitment loosens when retreat is pre-authorized.

Exercise 3: Ritual Handoff (15 min)

Intent — Anchor the promise to a shared object.

"Pass a stone / totem to each speaker. They hold it while making their promise, then place it in a shared bowl."

Materials — One small object per participant, one bowl.

Debrief — The bowl travels with the team to the next session.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day we all held the same stone.
- Cognitive — The model: commitment = smallest action + witness + undo clause.
- Identity — I am someone who ships a promise, not a plan.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Week 1 — Landing	Live · 6h	Love	Fears named, futures postcarded.
Week 2 — Reframe	Live · 6h + async · 4h	Magic	Tool-free workflow drawn.
Week 3-4 — Ontology	Live · 12h + async · 8h	Calm	Uncertainty map + season walkthrough.
Week 5-6 — Discovery	Live · 10h + async · 8h	Open	Named patterns + missing voices list.
Week 7 — Commit	Live · 6h	Free	Promise stones + Monday actions.
Week 8 — Witness	Async · 5h	Free	First check-in with witness.

Commitment contract

What is the smallest brave thing you will do by Monday?

By Monday I will _____. My witness is _____. If by day 30 _____ is true, I will stop and re-open the question.

Witness — One peer from the cohort, named before leaving the room.

Drift — Decision Sprint

Foreplay · Trainings · 60 hours over 6 weeks

60 hours of co-assisted development. Learn to think out loud with the machine without losing your own voice.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You stopped drafting alone. The machine became a thinking partner — one you could interrupt, correct and disagree with.

Cognitive — Drift = axis-aware co-thinking. Every prompt starts from one of the 5 Calm Magic axes (MAGIC/LOVE/CALM/OPEN/FREE) and stays legibly on it.

Identity — From prompt-hoarder to axis-holder. You know which axis you're on and when to switch.

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Reconnect to why you're outsourcing thinking in the first place.

Prompt: "What kind of thinking do you not want to hand over?"

Artifact — A signed Companion Contract on the wall.

Exercise 1: Non-Delegable List (10 min)

Intent — Name what must stay yours.

"List 5 kinds of thinking you refuse to outsource to a machine. One line each."

Materials — Notebook.

Debrief — Trade lists with a partner. Ask: 'Would you defend theirs?'

Exercise 2: Voice Print (15 min)

Intent — Establish your own baseline before drift.

"Write 200 words on a topic you love. Do not edit."

Materials — Blank page.

Debrief — Save it. You'll compare against machine-assisted drafts later.

Exercise 3: Companion Contract (10 min)

Intent — Set the terms of the relationship.

"Fill in: 'When I work with the machine I promise to ____ and I refuse to ____.'"

Materials — Card.

Debrief — Read aloud. Pin above your desk.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I named what stays mine before I let anything in.
- Cognitive — The model: co-thinking starts with sovereignty.
- Identity — I am someone with a voice-print I recognize.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — See the machine as a mirror, not an oracle.

Prompt: "What did the machine reflect back that you couldn't say yourself?"

Artifact — A screenshot of the round when the mirror clicked.

Exercise 1: Mirror Prompt (20 min)

Intent — Use the machine to reflect, not answer.

"Feed a rough idea; ask the machine to say back only what it heard, in your voice. Iterate 3 rounds."

Materials — AI chat.

Debrief — Ask: 'On which round did it start sounding like you?'

Exercise 2: Cognitive Handoff (15 min)

Intent — Practice giving one clear cognitive task.

"Assign the machine ONE bounded task ('list contradictions in this doc'). Nothing else."

Materials — AI chat, one doc.

Debrief — Ask: 'Where did you resist giving up more? Why?'

Exercise 3: Disagreement Drill (15 min)

Intent — Learn to say no to a confident machine.

"Pick a plausible-but-wrong output. Push back with evidence in 3 sentences."

Materials — AI output, notes.

Debrief — Ask: 'When did the machine concede? When should it have?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day the machine started sounding like me.
- Cognitive — The model: mirror > oracle. Bounded task > open request.
- Identity — I am someone who can disagree with a confident machine.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce the 5 Drift axes as a legible orientation system.

Prompt: "Which axis is this conversation actually on?"

Artifact — A tagged prompt history. Wall chart of axis distribution.

Exercise 1: Axis Tagging (20 min)

Intent — Learn to name the axis of every prompt.

"Take 10 prompts you've written this week. Tag each with MAGIC/LOVE/CALM/OPEN/FREE."

Materials — Prompt history export.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which axis is over-represented? Which is missing?'

Exercise 2: Single-Axis Run (30 min)

Intent — Stay on one axis end-to-end.

"Do one 30-min work session staying strictly on OPEN (workflow/ontology)."

Materials — AI chat, timer.

Debrief — Ask: 'What tempted you to switch? What did you gain by staying?'

Exercise 3: Axis Handoff (15 min)

Intent — Practice explicit axis switching.

"Move a conversation from MAGIC to CALM by announcing the switch out loud to the machine."

Materials — AI chat.

Debrief — Ask: 'Did the machine follow? Did YOU follow?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I learned to name the axis before I hit send.
- Cognitive — The model: 5 axes = 5 kinds of thinking. Name it or drift.
- Identity — I am someone who navigates axes, not prompts.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Discover your own drift patterns by looking at your history.

Prompt: "What does my week of prompts say I actually believe?"

Artifact — An axis distribution chart. A silent co-draft artifact.

Exercise 1: The Prompt Autopsy (25 min)

Intent — Read your own history as an anthropologist.

"In pairs, read a partner's prompt history. Report back what you think they care about."

Materials — Prompt exports (redacted if needed).

Debrief — Ask: 'What did they see that you couldn't?'

Exercise 2: Missing Axis Sprint (20 min)

Intent — Fill the axis you avoid.

"Do a 20-min session on the axis you've avoided this month."

Materials — AI chat.

Debrief — Ask: 'What made that axis feel forbidden?'

Exercise 3: Silent Co-Draft (45 min)

Intent — Draft with the machine without speaking to anyone else.

"45 min silent co-drafting. Timer. No Slack, no email."

Materials — Timer, AI chat.

Debrief — Group debrief on cadence, not content.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day I read my prompts like a diary.
- Cognitive — The model: your prompt history IS your working ontology.
- Identity — I am someone who is legible to myself.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — Ship one decision. Not one deck.

Prompt: "What decision will you make this week that Drift helped shape?"

Artifact — A one-page decision memo. A published co-thinking calendar.

Exercise 1: The One-Decision Memo (30 min)

Intent — Compress the sprint into one page.

"Write a 1-page memo: context, options, decision, undo clause. Machine helps only with structure."

Materials — Template.

Debrief — Circulate. Get one 'agree' and one 'push-back' before shipping.

Exercise 2: Machine-Free Sign-Off (15 min)

Intent — The final commitment happens without the machine.

"Read your memo aloud without the machine present. Change what feels borrowed."

Materials — Printed memo.

Debrief — Ask: 'What phrase did you cut?'

Exercise 3: Cadence Contract (10 min)

Intent — Set your co-thinking rhythm.

"Decide: which days do you drift with the machine? Which days do you draft alone?"

Materials — Calendar.

Debrief — Post the calendar to the team.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I shipped a decision the machine helped shape but did not sign.
- Cognitive — The model: co-thinking has a cadence. Solo thinking has a place.
- Identity — I am someone who ships decisions, not drafts.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Week 1 — Sovereignty	Live · 8h + async · 6h	Love	Companion Contract signed.
Week 2 — Mirror	Live · 6h + async · 6h	Magic	First mirror-click screenshot.
Week 3 — Axes	Live · 6h + async · 6h	Calm	Tagged prompt history.
Week 4 — Patterns	Live · 6h + async · 6h	Open	Prompt autopsy report.
Week 5 — Ship	Live · 6h + async · 4h	Free	One-decision memo shipped.
Week 6 — Cadence	Async · 6h	Free	Co-thinking calendar published.

Commitment contract

Which decision will you let Drift help you shape this month — and which will you keep entirely your own?

This month I will drift with the machine on _____. I will keep _____ entirely my own.

My co-thinking cadence is _____.

Witness — A colleague who reads your first memo before it ships.

Tune — Founder Companion

Foreplay · Trainings · 60 hours over 6 weeks

60 hours of orchestrated autonomy. Move from co-assisted drafting to running a small ensemble of agents on your behalf.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You stopped being the bottleneck. The ensemble drafts while you conduct.

Cognitive — Tune = orchestration ontology. Each agent has a role (voice, verifier, scribe, skeptic) and a bounded axis.

Identity — From soloist to conductor. From doing every note to shaping every phrase.

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Reclaim the part of the work that must stay conducted, not delegated.

Prompt: "What is the taste that only you can hold?"

Artifact — A conductor's chair with the manifesto posted above.

Exercise 1: Taste Inventory (15 min)

Intent — Name your non-negotiable aesthetic.

"List 7 things that must be true of anything shipped in your name."

Materials — Card.

Debrief — Read aloud. Notice which items surprise you.

Exercise 2: The Conductor's Chair (5 min)

Intent — Physically claim the role.

"Sit in one designated chair. Only from this chair do you make orchestration decisions."

Materials — One chair.

Debrief — Debrief the felt difference between conducting and doing.

Exercise 3: Ensemble Manifesto (15 min)

Intent — Declare what the ensemble is for.

"Draft a 3-line manifesto: purpose, boundary, promise."

Materials — Card.

Debrief — Post above the conductor's chair.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day I sat in the conductor's chair for the first time.
- Cognitive — The model: taste is data. Delegate everything except taste.
- Identity — I am someone who conducts, not performs.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — See orchestration as composition, not automation.

Prompt: "What ensemble arrangement did you not know was possible?"

Artifact — A cast-list of your ensemble. A color-coded transcript.

Exercise 1: Role Casting (20 min)

Intent — Assign specific roles to specific agents.

"Cast 4 agents: voice, verifier, scribe, skeptic. One-sentence job description each."

Materials — Agent config sheet.

Debrief — Debate the skeptic's brief hardest. That's where quality lives.

Exercise 2: Score Reading (25 min)

Intent — Read a completed multi-agent run like a score.

"Take a past transcript. Color-code each turn by which role should have spoken."

Materials — Transcript, 4 colors.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which role was silent when it should have played?'

Exercise 3: Cadenza (15 min)

Intent — Let one agent solo on purpose.

"Run one 15-min segment where only the skeptic speaks."

Materials — AI orchestrator.

Debrief — Notice what the ensemble learns when one voice is centered.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I heard my ensemble as music, not automation.
- Cognitive — The model: 4 roles. Each with a brief. Each with a right to silence.
- Identity — I am someone who composes with agents.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce orchestration ontology — the score itself.

Prompt: "What is the shape of the piece you're conducting?"

Artifact — A hand-drawn score. A governance-line document.

Exercise 1: The Score (40 min)

Intent — Draw your workflow as a musical score.

"Bars = phases. Staves = roles. Notes = handoffs. Draw one project."

Materials — Large paper, ruler.

Debrief — Ask: 'Where does the score have rests? Should it?'

Exercise 2: Handoff Protocol (25 min)

Intent — Formalize inter-agent handoffs.

"Write 3 handoff templates: voice → verifier, scribe → skeptic, skeptic → voice."

Materials — Templates.

Debrief — Test one live. Ask: 'What broke? What held?'

Exercise 3: Governance Line (15 min)

Intent — Draw the line the ensemble cannot cross.

"List 5 decisions only the conductor can make. Publish to the ensemble config."

Materials — Config file.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which of these could you delegate in 6 months?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I saw the score of my own workflow.
- Cognitive — The model: bars/staves/notes/rests. Handoffs are the melody.
- Identity — I am someone who reads and writes scores.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Discover where the ensemble surprises you — good and bad.

Prompt: "What emerged that no single agent — and no single you — could have made alone?"

Artifact — A surprise log. A retrospective document per role.

Exercise 1: Surprise Log (60 min)

Intent — Track ensemble emergent behavior.

"For one week, log every output that surprised you (good or bad). One line each."

Materials — Log template.

Debrief — In group: cluster the surprises. Ask: 'Which want to become features?'

Exercise 2: The Silent Skeptic (180 min)

Intent — Rest the skeptic and see what fails.

"Run 3 days with the skeptic silenced. Track quality shift."

Materials — Config toggle.

Debrief — Debrief: 'What did the skeptic protect that you didn't notice?'

Exercise 3: Ensemble Retrospective (20 min)

Intent — Let the ensemble evaluate itself.

"Ask each role to write a 3-line self-assessment. Read them aloud."

Materials — AI orchestrator.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which self-assessment did you disagree with?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the week I turned off the skeptic and watched quality drift.
- Cognitive — The model: emergence is measurable. Silence is a diagnostic.
- Identity — I am someone who studies my ensemble like a live system.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — Ship one thing the ensemble ran end-to-end. Under your baton.

Prompt: "What did the ensemble ship this month that you only conducted?"

Artifact — A conducted-only deliverable. A second-chair onboarding doc.

Exercise 1: The Baton Test (240 min)

Intent — Run one full project by conducting only.

"Pick one small deliverable. You may only prompt, tune roles, and approve. No drafting."

Materials — Full ensemble config.

Debrief — Publish the deliverable with a byline: 'Conducted by _____. Performed by ensemble.'

Exercise 2: Cost of Conducting (30 min)

Intent — Measure what conducting actually took.

"Log your minutes: prompting, tuning, approving. Nothing else."

Materials — Time-tracking log.

Debrief — Ask: 'Did the ensemble save time — or shift what your time was worth?'

Exercise 3: Second-Chair Handoff (30 min)

Intent — Prepare someone else to conduct.

"Write a 1-page onboarding for the next conductor of your ensemble."

Materials — Template.

Debrief — Have them run one segment under your baton.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the week I published something I only conducted.
- Cognitive — The model: conducting is a measurable role. It has minutes and outputs.
- Identity — I am someone who can hand my baton to someone else.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Week 1 — Chair	Live · 8h + async · 4h	Love	Manifesto and chair claimed.
Week 2 — Cast	Live · 6h + async · 6h	Magic	4-role cast list published.
Week 3 — Score	Live · 8h + async · 6h	Calm	Hand-drawn score of one workflow.
Week 4 — Surprise	Live · 4h + async · 10h	Open	One-week surprise log.
Week 5 — Baton	Live · 4h + async · 8h	Free	Conducted-only deliverable shipped.
Week 6 — Handoff	Async · 6h	Free	Second-chair onboarding doc.

Commitment contract

What will your ensemble ship this month that you will only conduct?

This month my ensemble will ship _____. I will only _____ (prompt / tune / approve). The second chair I am preparing is _____.

Witness — The person named as your second chair.

Think Like a Forest

Foresight · Retreats · 3 days on land

A 3-day forest retreat that teaches leadership teams to sense in canopies, roots and mycelium instead of orgcharts.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You walked into a forest expecting a metaphor and left with a decision system.

Cognitive — Forest ontology: canopy (vision), trunk (structure), roots (values), mycelium (relational intelligence).

Identity — From org-chart holder to canopy-reader.

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Slow the body enough for slower thoughts to arrive.

Prompt: "What did you already know before you walked in?"

Artifact — A fire of unanswered questions.

Exercise 1: The Long Arrival (40 min)

Intent — Land through the body.

"Walk 40 minutes in silence to the site. No phones."

Materials — A path.

Debrief — Circle-check: 'What did the walk do to your first sentence?'

Exercise 2: Root Introduction (20 min)

Intent — Introduce yourself through what holds you.

"One-line intro: 'What holds me is ____.' No job titles."

Materials — Circle.

Debrief — Notice what is not said.

Exercise 3: The Fire Question (25 min)

Intent — Ask the question you brought.

"Speak the one question you carried into the forest. Then place a stick on the fire."

Materials — Fire, sticks.

Debrief — No responses. The question stays.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day I walked in and no one asked my title.
- Cognitive — The model: arrival takes time. Speed is a lens.
- Identity — I am someone who arrives slowly.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — Break the org-chart lens with a living-system lens.

Prompt: "What if your team is a canopy, not a hierarchy?"

Artifact — A canopy sketch, a mycelium map, a deadwood inventory.

Exercise 1: Canopy Mapping (30 min)

Intent — Look up. Really look up.

"Spend 30 min in one spot studying the canopy above. Sketch what you see."

Materials — Sketchbook.

Debrief — Ask: 'What role does your team play in your org's canopy?'

Exercise 2: Mycelium Walk (60 min)

Intent — Follow the invisible connections.

"Walk with a guide who points out the mycelial network of one hectare."

Materials — Guide.

Debrief — Ask: 'Where are the mycelial channels in your org?'

Exercise 3: Deadwood Inventory (30 min)

Intent — Honor what's decaying productively.

"Find deadwood in the forest. List what it feeds."

Materials — Notebook.

Debrief — Ask: 'What in your org is decaying productively?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day I saw my team as a canopy.
- Cognitive — The model: canopy / trunk / roots / mycelium / deadwood.
- Identity — I am someone who reads living systems.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Turn the forest lens into an org-legible framework.

Prompt: "What is the shape of your organizational forest?"

Artifact — A forest blueprint of the organization.

Exercise 1: The Forest Blueprint (60 min)

Intent — Draw your org as a forest.

"Draw: canopy (vision), trunks (functions), roots (values), mycelium (relational intelligence), deadwood (legacy)."

Materials — Large paper.

Debrief — Present to the group. Take questions.

Exercise 2: Season Overlay (30 min)

Intent — Assign a forest season to each initiative.

"Every current initiative gets a season: seed / growth / flower / harvest / decay."

Materials — Initiative list.

Debrief — Ask: 'Are we planting when we should be harvesting?'

Exercise 3: Keystone Species (20 min)

Intent — Identify who cannot leave without collapse.

"Name 3 keystone people. Name 3 keystone practices."

Materials — Notebook.

Debrief — Ask: 'How do we protect the keystones without freezing the forest?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day my org became a forest on paper.
- Cognitive — The model: canopy/trunk/roots/mycelium/deadwood × seasons × keystones.
- Identity — I am someone who can draw my org as a living system.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Sit still long enough for the forest to speak back.

Prompt: "What has the forest been telling you that you weren't hearing?"

Artifact — A day of weather reads. A council transcript.

Exercise 1: Sit Spot (60 min)

Intent — One hour, one place, no output.

"Choose a spot. Sit for 60 min. Do not journal until the hour is up."

Materials — A cushion.

Debrief — Only after: write one paragraph.

Exercise 2: Council of Trees (45 min)

Intent — Let others speak as parts of the forest.

"In circle, each person speaks as a tree, root, animal, or stream about the org."

Materials — Circle.

Debrief — Notice which voice keeps returning.

Exercise 3: Weather Read (240 min)

Intent — Track the emotional weather of the group.

"Hourly: one word for the group's weather. Post to a shared board."

Materials — Board.

Debrief — End of day: read the weather pattern.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the hour I sat and the forest changed my mind.
- Cognitive — The model: sensing is a discipline, not a mood.
- Identity — I am someone who lets the system speak first.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — Return with one decision the forest helped shape.

Prompt: "What decision are you carrying back down the mountain?"

Artifact — A sealed letter. A planted seed. A named keystone commitment.

Exercise 1: The Descent Letter (30 min)

Intent — Write yourself a letter to open Monday.

"Handwritten letter to open at 9am Monday. Seal it."

Materials — Paper, envelope.

Debrief — Trust the forest self more than the Monday self.

Exercise 2: Keystone Commitment (15 min)

Intent — Commit to protecting one keystone.

"Name the keystone and the protection. State it in circle."

Materials — Circle.

Debrief — Witness assigned by the group.

Exercise 3: Seed Package (5 min)

Intent — Take one physical seed home.

"Take one physical seed. Plant it within 7 days. Photo when it sprouts."

Materials — Seed packet.

Debrief — The sprout is your first status report.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I came home with a letter I hadn't yet read.
- Cognitive — The model: descent needs ritual. Seeds are metrics too.
- Identity — I am someone who honors what the forest told me.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Day 1 — Arrival	6h	Love	Fire of questions lit.
Day 1 evening — Reframe	3h	Magic	Canopy sketch begun.
Day 2 morning — Framework	4h	Calm	Forest blueprint drawn.
Day 2 afternoon — Sensing	5h	Open	Sit spot + council held.
Day 3 — Descent	5h	Free	Descent letter sealed. Seed taken.

Commitment contract

Which keystone will you protect between now and the next equinox?

Between now and _____ I will protect the keystone of _____ by _____. My witness in the circle is _____.

Witness — One person from the retreat circle.

Stories of a Near Future

Foresight · Retreats · 4 days

A 4-day writing retreat where leadership teams draft the 2030 they would rather have — and stress-test it against evidence.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You stopped forecasting and started writing. The 2030 you wrote is now a document your team can argue with.

Cognitive — Preferable-futures ontology: writing → evidence → back-cast → decision. Fiction as due diligence.

Identity — From strategist to storyteller-with-receipts.

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Establish the emotional stakes of the future being written.

Prompt: "Whose 2030 are you writing? Whose are you not?"

Artifact — A pile of dispatches from 2030.

Exercise 1: The Beneficiary List (20 min)

Intent — Name who benefits and who doesn't.

"List 10 beneficiaries of your imagined 2030. Then 10 non-beneficiaries."

Materials — Notebook.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which list did you write faster?'

Exercise 2: First-Person Dispatch (45 min)

Intent — Write as someone living in 2030.

"First-person 1-page dispatch from 2030, as a stakeholder — not you."

Materials — Blank page.

Debrief — Read aloud. Only listen.

Exercise 3: The Cost Question (15 min)

Intent — Name what this future costs.

"Every good future costs something. Write one paragraph: 'This future cost us ____'."

Materials — Card.

Debrief — Debate as a group: 'Is that cost bearable?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I wrote 2030 as someone other than myself.
- Cognitive — The model: futures have beneficiaries. Beneficiaries have opposites.
- Identity — I am someone who writes futures with receipts.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — Break linear extrapolation with a discontinuity exercise.

Prompt: "What breaks between now and 2030 that you're not modelling?"

Artifact — A wall of discontinuity cards and cluster of weak signals.

Exercise 1: Discontinuity Cards (30 min)

Intent — Force a break in the timeline.

"Draw a random discontinuity card. Rewrite your dispatch integrating it."

Materials — Prepared card deck.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which cards did the group refuse to draw twice?'

Exercise 2: The Weird Signal (30 min)

Intent — Bring evidence of the discontinuity happening now.

"Each person shares one weak signal from the last 6 months."

Materials — Signal notes.

Debrief — Cluster signals. Vote on which are most under-priced.

Exercise 3: Time Slice (45 min)

Intent — Rewrite the dispatch from a different year.

"Rewrite the same scene as 2027, then 2033. Compare."

Materials — Blank pages.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which version scared you more?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the card that forced my future to break.
- Cognitive — The model: discontinuities compound. Linear futures are the fantasy.
- Identity — I am someone who plans for weird.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce back-casting as the framework linking story to decision.

Prompt: "What would have to be true in 2027 for your 2030 to be true?"

Artifact — A back-cast sheet per team.

Exercise 1: The Back-Cast (40 min)

Intent — Fill the middle.

"Given your 2030 dispatch, list the 5 milestones of 2028, 2027, 2026."

Materials — Timeline sheet.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which milestone is missing from your current roadmap?'

Exercise 2: Evidence Column (30 min)

Intent — Every milestone needs a source.

"Add one column: what evidence today makes each milestone plausible?"

Materials — Sheet.

Debrief — Circle the milestones with no evidence. Those are your bets.

Exercise 3: The Cost Column (20 min)

Intent — What must you sacrifice at each milestone?

"Add one column: what must be stopped or shrunk?"

Materials — Sheet.

Debrief — Ask: 'Are you willing?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day I saw 2026 in my 2030.
- Cognitive — The model: back-cast = milestones × evidence × cost.
- Identity — I am someone who back-casts before they forecast.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Peer critique. Fiction as due diligence.

Prompt: "What holes did other people find in your future?"

Artifact — A court transcript. A skeptical-review binder.

Exercise 1: Story Court (60 min)

Intent — Present a dispatch. Get cross-examined.

"One team presents. Two teams cross-examine. One team defends."

Materials — Court setup.

Debrief — Change roles every 30 min.

Exercise 2: The Skeptic's Read (20 min)

Intent — Read one dispatch as a skeptical journalist.

"Write a 1-paragraph skeptical review of another team's dispatch."

Materials — Card.

Debrief — Give it to the author. Silent read.

Exercise 3: Insurance Question (25 min)

Intent — What would you insure this future against?

"List 5 risks and the price of insuring against each."

Materials — Notebook.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which insurance can't you afford to skip?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the story that survived the court.
- Cognitive — The model: peer critique is a due-diligence protocol.
- Identity — I am someone who submits my future for cross-examination.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — Turn the surviving story into a decision.

Prompt: "What one decision does this story now require?"

Artifact — A decision card. A bet-sizing sheet. A handoff appointment.

Exercise 1: The Story-to-Decision Bridge (30 min)

Intent — Compress story into a decision.

"Write: 'If our 2030 is true, then before ____ we must decide ____.'"

Materials — Card.

Debrief — Read aloud. Notice repetition.

Exercise 2: Bet Sizing (25 min)

Intent — Size the bet against the evidence.

"For each decision: what's the smallest bet that would test it?"

Materials — Bet card.

Debrief — Publish the bet sizes.

Exercise 3: Story Handoff (10 min)

Intent — Give your story to someone outside the room.

"Name one person who needs this story before the quarter ends."

Materials — Handoff card.

Debrief — Schedule the handoff before leaving.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I brought a story home that made one decision obvious.
- Cognitive — The model: story → decision → smallest test → handoff.
- Identity — I am someone whose stories become decisions.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Day 1 — Stakes	6h	Love	First dispatches read.
Day 2 — Break	6h	Magic	Discontinuity integrated.
Day 3 morning — Back-cast	4h	Calm	Milestones + evidence + cost.
Day 3 afternoon — Court	4h	Open	Story survives court.
Day 4 — Decide	5h	Free	Decision cards + handoffs.

Commitment contract

What is the one decision your near-future story now requires?

If our 2030 is _____, then before _____ we must decide _____. The smallest bet that tests this is _____. The person who needs this story is _____.

Witness — The person you named for handoff.

Relational Intelligence Summit

Foresight · Retreats · 2 days

A 2-day summit where senior teams practice the muscle their org uses least — reading and repairing the relational field.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You realized the org's real bottleneck was relational, not technical.

Cognitive — Relational intelligence: field-reading, rupture-and-repair, brave dissent, boundary as clarity.

Identity — From performance manager to field reader.

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Establish felt safety before any hard truth is spoken.

Prompt: "What would need to be true for you to speak the truth here?"

Artifact — A wall of safety signals. A shared repair story.

Exercise 1: Safety Signals (15 min)

Intent — Name what safety looks and sounds like.

"Each person: 3 signals of safety and 3 signals of danger in a room."

Materials — Cards.

Debrief — Post on the wall as a shared field guide.

Exercise 2: Speed of Trust Line (15 min)

Intent — Physically map trust.

"Line: 'trust is fast here' to 'trust is slow here'. Move. Speak."

Materials — Tape line.

Debrief — Ask: 'What would move you two steps up?'

Exercise 3: Repair Story (30 min)

Intent — Share one repair you're proud of.

"Tell a 3-min story of a repair — personal or professional."

Materials — Pairs.

Debrief — Notice which repairs the room already knows how to do.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day I named what safety costs.
- Cognitive — The model: safety = signal literacy + repair history.
- Identity — I am someone who names safety before I demand truth.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — Show that the field is legible — and you're already reading it.

Prompt: "What did you already know that no one had named?"

Artifact — A field-read transcript. A rupture-in-slow-motion map.

Exercise 1: Field Read (20 min)

Intent — Practice narrating the room out loud.

"One volunteer narrates the room's felt sense for 3 min. Others correct."

Materials — Timer.

Debrief — Rotate. Notice the corrections.

Exercise 2: The Unspoken (20 min)

Intent — Name the thing everyone knows and no one says.

"In pairs: 'What does everyone in your team know but no one names?'"

Materials — Pairs.

Debrief — Group harvest — only volunteered items.

Exercise 3: Micro-Rupture Study (30 min)

Intent — Rewind a small rupture in slow motion.

"Recall a 5-minute rupture. Map: trigger → escalation → recovery."

Materials — Timeline sheet.

Debrief — Ask: 'Where could repair have happened one step earlier?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day I said what I always knew.
- Cognitive — The model: fields are readable. Reading is a practice.
- Identity — I am someone who reads before I react.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce the relational intelligence framework.

Prompt: "What are the moves in the relational playbook?"

Artifact — A four-moves cheat card. A rewritten rule set.

Exercise 1: The Four Moves (45 min)

Intent — Teach: name, own, ask, offer.

"Practice each move in scripted pairs."

Materials — Script sheet.

Debrief — Debrief: 'Which move is hardest for you?'

Exercise 2: Boundary as Clarity (30 min)

Intent — Distinguish boundaries from walls.

"Rewrite 3 org rules as boundaries (offers), not walls (restrictions)."

Materials — Rule list.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which felt easier to say aloud?'

Exercise 3: The Brave Dissent Protocol (30 min)

Intent — Teach the protocol.

"Practice dissenting inside the protocol on a low-stakes topic."

Materials — Protocol card.

Debrief — Debrief cadence, not content.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I learned the four moves.
- Cognitive — The model: name, own, ask, offer. Boundaries = offers.
- Identity — I am someone who uses the four moves in real meetings.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Practice on a real, unresolved organizational tension.

Prompt: "Which real tension are you willing to bring into this room?"

Artifact — A rehearsed repair script per participant.

Exercise 1: Tension Bring-Along (45 min)

Intent — Bring a live tension.

"Volunteer one team brings a real tension. Others hold field."

Materials — Circle.

Debrief — Reflect only. Do not solve.

Exercise 2: Amplification Round (20 min)

Intent — Amplify what wasn't heard.

"Each observer amplifies one thing they heard but wasn't received."

Materials — Circle.

Debrief — Ask the bringing team: 'What changed by hearing this?'

Exercise 3: The Repair Rehearsal (30 min)

Intent — Rehearse the repair conversation you owe.

"In pairs: rehearse the actual conversation you've been avoiding."

Materials — Pairs.

Debrief — Ask: 'What made it easier to say here?'

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the tension I said out loud without dying.
- Cognitive — The model: bringing + amplification + rehearsal = actionable repair.
- Identity — I am someone who brings tensions into rooms.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — Commit to one real repair on the calendar.

Prompt: "Which repair will happen on your calendar this week?"

Artifact — A calendar invite. An after-card. A 30-day check-in date.

Exercise 1: The Repair Appointment (10 min)

Intent — Put it on the calendar in the room.

"Send the calendar invite before you leave the room."

Materials — Phone.

Debrief — Show the invite to your witness.

Exercise 2: The After-Card (15 min)

Intent — Design what you'll do after.

"Write 3 lines: opening, hardest sentence, what you'll offer."

Materials — Card.

Debrief — Read to your witness. Adjust the hardest sentence.

Exercise 3: Community Practice Pact (5 min)

Intent — Meet the group again in 30 days.

"Set a 30-min group check-in date now."

Materials — Calendar.

Debrief — Assign a host.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: I put the repair on the calendar in the room.
- Cognitive — The model: commitment = invite + script + follow-up.
- Identity — I am someone who schedules the repair I owe.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Day 1 morning — Safety	4h	Love	Safety signals posted.
Day 1 afternoon — Field	4h	Magic	Field-read practiced.
Day 2 morning — Moves	4h	Calm	Four moves rehearsed.
Day 2 afternoon — Real	3h	Open	One real tension worked.
Day 2 closing — Commit	1h	Free	Repair appointment scheduled.

Commitment contract

Which repair will you schedule on your calendar before leaving this room?

This week I will have the repair conversation with _____ on _____. My opening line is _____. My witness is _____.

Witness — One peer from the summit circle.

GL!TCH — Diagnostic Sprint

Forecast · Residencies · 3 weeks embedded

A 3-week embedded residency to diagnose where the real bottleneck lives before anyone writes code.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You stopped building the wrong thing. The three weeks of diagnosis saved six months of shipping.

Cognitive — Diagnosis > prototype > production. Every symptom is mapped to a root before any solution is drawn.

Identity — From feature-shipper to root-cause diagnostician.

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Establish shared understanding of what the org is protecting.

Prompt: "What is this org afraid the diagnosis will find?"

Artifact — A signed no-blame contract. A fear map. Success criteria.

Exercise 1: Stakeholder Fears (150 min)

Intent — Interview 5 stakeholders for their fear.

"One 30-min interview each. Only question: 'What are you afraid we'll find?'"

Materials — Interview kit.

Debrief — Cluster fears. Publish the fear map.

Exercise 2: The No-Blame Contract (45 min)

Intent — Set the diagnostic frame.

"Draft and co-sign a 1-page no-blame diagnostic contract."

Materials — Template.

Debrief — Read aloud in the kickoff. Post to Slack.

Exercise 3: Success Definition (60 min)

Intent — Define success for the sprint.

"Facilitated session: 'A successful diagnosis is one that ____.'"

Materials — Whiteboard.

Debrief — Convert to 5 measurable success criteria.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the org signed a no-blame contract before we started looking.
- Cognitive — The model: diagnosis before treatment. Fears before findings.
- Identity — I am someone who names fear before I fix.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — Show that symptoms are almost never the problem.

Prompt: "Which symptom has been hiding the actual problem?"

Artifact — A clustered symptom wall. A root-trace document. A false-problem list.

Exercise 1: Symptom Wall (240 min)

Intent — Post every complaint as a symptom.

"One week of Slack, tickets, meeting notes. Every complaint → sticky note."

Materials — Wall.

Debrief — Cluster. Ask: 'Which cluster surprises you?'

Exercise 2: Root Trace (90 min)

Intent — Trace 3 symptoms to root.

"Pick 3 symptoms. Ask 'why' 5 times each."

Materials — Trace sheet.

Debrief — Present to leadership. Note their reaction.

Exercise 3: The False-Problem List (30 min)

Intent — Name the problems that aren't problems.

"List 3 things everyone treats as problems that aren't."

Materials — Card.

Debrief — Circulate to leadership. Ask for pushback.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day we named the symptom that was hiding the problem.
- Cognitive — The model: symptoms cluster. Roots reveal.
- Identity — I am someone who resists solving the wrong problem.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce the diagnostic framework: 5-season × 5-state grid.

Prompt: "In which season and which state does this org break?"

Artifact — A scored grid. A 5-page diagnostic report.

Exercise 1: The Grid Score (180 min)

Intent — Score the org on the 25-cell grid.

"For each cell: 1-5 score with 1-line evidence."

Materials — Grid template.

Debrief — Present to leadership as diagnostic.

Exercise 2: Missing Cell Interview (240 min)

Intent — Interview the cell with lowest score.

"Book 3 more interviews around that cell."

Materials — Interview kit.

Debrief — Ask: 'What does this cell need to become a 3?'

Exercise 3: The Diagnostic Report (480 min)

Intent — Write a 5-page diagnostic.

"One page per season. State score per cell. Root cause per season."

Materials — Report template.

Debrief — Circulate. Get one leader signature per season.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day the whole org fit on one grid.
- Cognitive — The model: 5 seasons × 5 states = 25 diagnostic cells.
- Identity — I am someone who diagnoses on a grid.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Present findings and let the org argue with them.

Prompt: "What did we get wrong in our diagnosis?"

Artifact — A pushback log. A v2 diagnostic. A public-wall photo.

Exercise 1: The Findings Read-Out (90 min)

Intent — Live present findings to leadership.

"90-min read-out. 30 min findings, 60 min pushback."

Materials — Presentation.

Debrief — Log every pushback verbatim.

Exercise 2: Pushback Integration (240 min)

Intent — Rewrite the diagnostic based on pushback.

"Integrate top 5 pushbacks. Publish v2."

Materials — v2 doc.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which pushback changed the diagnosis?'

Exercise 3: The Public Wall (60 min)

Intent — Post the diagnostic where anyone can see.

"Print. Post in the largest common space."

Materials — Print + tape.

Debrief — Note who stops to read. Talk to them.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the day leadership pushed back and we listened.
- Cognitive — The model: diagnosis is a draft. Pushback is signal.
- Identity — I am someone who publishes a diagnostic in public.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — Recommend one — and only one — thing.

Prompt: "What is the smallest thing that would unblock everything else?"

Artifact — A one-page recommendation. A signed bet. A prototype brief.

Exercise 1: The One Recommendation (90 min)

Intent — One page. One recommendation.

"One page: recommendation, rationale, cost, undo condition."

Materials — One-pager.

Debrief — Present to leadership. No slides.

Exercise 2: The Bet Contract (45 min)

Intent — Formalize the bet.

"Sign a 1-page bet: recommendation → success metric → 90-day check."

Materials — Bet template.

Debrief — Post the bet to the team.

Exercise 3: Handoff to Prototype (90 min)

Intent — Prepare the prototype residency brief.

"Draft the 1-page brief for the next residency."

Materials — Brief template.

Debrief — Handoff meeting with the next team.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: we shipped one page that saved six months.
- Cognitive — The model: one recommendation. One bet. One handoff.
- Identity — I am someone who ships one page, not fifty.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Week 1 — Landing	40h	Love	No-blame contract signed.
Week 1-2 — Symptom map	30h	Magic	Symptom wall + roots.
Week 2 — Grid score	20h	Calm	5-page diagnostic v1.
Week 3 — Read-out	20h	Open	Public v2 diagnostic.
Week 3 — Bet	10h	Free	One-page bet signed.

Commitment contract

What one thing will this org bet on based on this diagnostic?

Based on this diagnostic, _____ will bet on _____ by _____. The success metric is _____. The undo condition is _____.

Witness — One member of the executive team.

Drift — Prototype Residency

Forecast · Residencies · 8 weeks embedded

An 8-week embedded residency to build the working prototype that proves — or breaks — the diagnostic bet.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You stopped debating the roadmap. The prototype settled the argument in six weeks.

Cognitive — Prototypes Garden: structured foresight scenarios wired to real data, real users, real ROI.

Identity — From meeting-holder to prototype-holder.

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Anchor the residency on the diagnostic bet's why.

Prompt: "Why did this org bet on this?"

Artifact — A wall of user stories. Refreshed fear map.

Exercise 1: Bet Recital (15 min)

Intent — Read the bet aloud.

"Kickoff opens by reading the diagnostic bet verbatim."

Materials — Bet doc.

Debrief — No commentary. Just witnessed.

Exercise 2: User Story from the Bet (90 min)

Intent — One user story per beneficiary.

"Draft one user story per beneficiary of the bet."

Materials — Story template.

Debrief — Post to the residency room wall.

Exercise 3: The Fear Refresh (150 min)

Intent — Re-run stakeholder fears.

"Ask 5 stakeholders: 'What are you afraid the prototype will show?'"

Materials — Interview kit.

Debrief — Compare to diagnostic fear map.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: we opened by reading the bet aloud.
- Cognitive — The model: the bet is the north star, not the backlog.
- Identity — I am someone who reads the why before the how.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — Break the default 'MVP' lens with 'evidence prototype'.

Prompt: "What is the smallest thing that would count as evidence?"

Artifact — A sketchbook of evidence. Fake-screen test logs.

Exercise 1: Evidence Sketch (60 min)

Intent — Sketch the evidence before the product.

"Draw what a proof-image would look like. What screen? What chart? What quote?"

Materials — Sketchbook.

Debrief — Ask: 'What's the smallest thing that would move the room?'

Exercise 2: The Fake-Screen Test (240 min)

Intent — Test with a fake screenshot.

"Show one hand-drawn screen to 5 real users. Log reactions."

Materials — Sketches, 5 users.

Debrief — Ask: 'Did the sketch move them more than a real product would have?'

Exercise 3: Wizard-of-Oz Round (180 min)

Intent — Fake the backend with a human.

"Run one full user interaction with a human in the loop."

Materials — One human, one form.

Debrief — Log every question the human couldn't answer.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the sketch that moved the room before we built anything.
- Cognitive — The model: evidence > MVP. Fake first, code second.
- Identity — I am someone who ships evidence before product.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce the Prototypes Garden framework.

Prompt: "Which garden bed does this prototype belong in?"

Artifact — A bed assignment. Bed-specific criteria. Risk card.

Exercise 1: Garden Bed Assignment (60 min)

Intent — Assign to a bed.

"Pick: signal-testing, workflow, ontology, business-model, ecosystem. Justify."

Materials — Framework poster.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which bed did we default to? Was it right?'

Exercise 2: Bed-Specific Success Criteria (45 min)

Intent — Each bed has its own metrics.

"Write the 3 success criteria specific to this bed."

Materials — Template.

Debrief — Circulate. Signal criteria differ from workflow criteria.

Exercise 3: Cross-Bed Risk (30 min)

Intent — Name the risk of being in this bed.

"Every bed has a failure mode. Name yours."

Materials — Risk card.

Debrief — Post next to the prototype wall.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: we chose one bed. On purpose.
- Cognitive — The model: 5 garden beds. Each with its own metrics.
- Identity — I am someone who plants prototypes in named beds.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Build, test, learn — publicly.

Prompt: "What is the prototype telling us that we didn't expect?"

Artifact — 8 weekly demo recordings. A failure log. Skeptic session notes.

Exercise 1: The Weekly Demo (45 min)

Intent — One 45-min demo every week. Public.

"Anyone in the org can attend. Log surprises."

Materials — Recurring meeting.

Debrief — Post the demo recording each week.

Exercise 2: Failure Log (60 min)

Intent — Publish every failure.

"Weekly note: what didn't work and why. Public channel."

Materials — Slack channel.

Debrief — Ask: 'Which failure taught the most?'

Exercise 3: The Skeptic's Session (60 min)

Intent — Invite the loudest skeptic.

"Book a 60-min session with the person most likely to reject the prototype."

Materials — Skeptic.

Debrief — Log every objection. Address 3 next week.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the week we published every failure.
- Cognitive — The model: public build > private polish.
- Identity — I am someone who demos in public and logs failure.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — Decide: kill, extend, or productionize.

Prompt: "Did the prototype prove or break the bet?"

Artifact — A written verdict. A post- or pre-mortem. A handoff package.

Exercise 1: The Verdict Meeting (90 min)

Intent — One meeting. One verdict.

"90-min meeting. Verdict: kill / extend / productionize. In writing."

Materials — Verdict template.

Debrief — Read the verdict to the team same day.

Exercise 2: Post-Mortem or Pre-Mortem (180 min)

Intent — Write one, no matter the verdict.

"Kill → post-mortem. Productionize → pre-mortem for launch."

Materials — Templates.

Debrief — Both circulated to the org.

Exercise 3: The Handoff Package (240 min)

Intent — Everything needed for the next team.

"Bundle: prototype, evidence, verdict, post/pre-mortem, next-30-days plan."

Materials — Handoff doc.

Debrief — Deliver to next team. Sign off.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: we shipped a verdict, not a demo.
- Cognitive — The model: kill / extend / productionize. All are shipping.
- Identity — I am someone who ships verdicts.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Week 1 — Bet recital	40h	Love	User stories wall built.
Week 2 — Fake first	40h	Magic	Fake-screen tests logged.
Week 3 — Bed choice	40h	Calm	Bed + criteria + risk posted.
Weeks 4-7 — Public build	160h	Open	4 weekly demos + failure log.
Week 8 — Verdict	40h	Free	Verdict + handoff package.

Commitment contract

What is the verdict on the diagnostic bet?

The prototype verdict is _____. The evidence is _____. The next 30 days will _____. The receiving team is _____.

Witness — The executive sponsor of the bet.

Tune — Ecosystem Build

Forecast · Residencies · 12 weeks embedded

A 12-week embedded residency to move from a validated prototype to an orchestrated ecosystem the org can run without us.

Three simultaneous journeys

Narrative — You stopped needing us. The ecosystem now runs on your team's baton.

Cognitive — Ecosystem = product + governance + rituals + second-chair. Every piece has an owner and a retirement date.

Identity — From project team to system stewards.

01. Love — Why this matters

Intent — Anchor on the humans who will run the ecosystem after us.

Prompt: "Who is the person who will own this in 12 weeks?"

Artifact — An owner grid. A signed handoff contract per piece.

Exercise 1: Owner Naming (90 min)

Intent — Name owners on day one.

"Assign owner + backup for every piece of the ecosystem."

Materials — Owner grid.

Debrief — Post to residency wall.

Exercise 2: The Owner's Fear (240 min)

Intent — Interview each owner.

"30-min interview per owner: 'What are you afraid you'll be left holding?'"

Materials — Interview kit.

Debrief — Cluster fears. Address top 3 in week 2.

Exercise 3: The Handoff Contract (120 min)

Intent — Design the handoff before starting.

"Co-draft: what will be handed off, in what shape, on what date."

Materials — Contract.

Debrief — Every owner signs.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: we named the humans before we shipped the system.
- Cognitive — The model: handoff is designed, not improvised.
- Identity — I am someone who names owners before I build.

02. Magic — The reframe

Intent — Reframe: an ecosystem is a set of rituals, not a set of features.

Prompt: "Which rituals will keep this ecosystem alive after we leave?"

Artifact — A ritual inventory. A cost sheet. A retirement document.

Exercise 1: Ritual Inventory (120 min)

Intent — Name every needed ritual.

"List: cadence, purpose, host, artifact, participants for each ritual."

Materials — Ritual template.

Debrief — Present to leadership. Get pushback.

Exercise 2: Ritual Cost (45 min)

Intent — Cost each ritual in hours per month.

"For each ritual: total hours consumed per month."

Materials — Cost sheet.

Debrief — Sum. Ask: 'Can the org afford this?'

Exercise 3: The Rituals Retirement (60 min)

Intent — Kill 30% of them.

"Kill 30% of rituals. Justify each kill."

Materials — Retirement doc.

Debrief — Publish. Notice the relief.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: we killed 30% of the rituals and no one noticed.
- Cognitive — The model: ecosystem = rituals × owners × artifacts. Retire ruthlessly.
- Identity — I am someone who costs rituals in hours.

03. Calm — Organize complexity

Intent — Introduce the governance ontology.

Prompt: "Who decides what, on what cadence, with what evidence?"

Artifact — RACI-lite grid. Cadence map. 1-page constitution.

Exercise 1: RACI-lite (90 min)

Intent — Simplest possible governance grid.

"For each decision type: responsible, accountable, informed. No consultation column."

Materials — Grid.

Debrief — Publish. Get exec sign-off.

Exercise 2: Cadence Map (120 min)

Intent — Draw the org's decision cadence.

"Which decisions weekly, monthly, quarterly? On what evidence?"

Materials — Cadence map.

Debrief — Post next to RACI-lite.

Exercise 3: The Constitution (240 min)

Intent — 1-page constitution for the ecosystem.

"Draft: purpose, boundary, decision protocol, retirement clause."

Materials — Template.

Debrief — All owners co-sign.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: we shipped a 1-page constitution.
- Cognitive — The model: RACI-lite × cadence map × constitution = governance.
- Identity — I am someone who governs on one page.

04. Open — Pattern discovery

Intent — Let the ecosystem run — with us in the room but silent.

Prompt: "What broke when we stayed silent?"

Artifact — A break-fix log. A team-led retro record.

Exercise 1: Silent Weeks (900 min)

Intent — Weeks 8-10, we don't speak in meetings.

"Attend. Take notes. Do not speak. Log what broke."

Materials — Notebook.

Debrief — Weekly retro with the team — using notes only.

Exercise 2: The Break-Fix Log (60 min)

Intent — Log every break, every fix.

"Public log. Owner names the fix."

Materials — Log.

Debrief — Notice which breaks the team fixed themselves.

Exercise 3: The First Retro Without Us (90 min)

Intent — Attend but don't speak.

"Facilitator: internal team lead. We only take notes."

Materials — Retro template.

Debrief — Debrief privately with the lead.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: the week we stayed silent and the team held.
- Cognitive — The model: silence is a diagnostic. Fixes are the metric.
- Identity — I am someone who leaves before I'm asked to.

05. Free — Commitment

Intent — Exit. Cleanly. On the date.

Prompt: "What did we hand over and what did we take with us?"

Artifact — An exit ceremony recording. 30/60/90 check-in schedule. Certificates.

Exercise 1: The Exit Ceremony (90 min)

Intent — Formal, public, on the calendar.

"90-min ceremony. Handoff of every piece. Public celebration."

Materials — Room + refreshments.

Debrief — Video the ceremony. Post.

Exercise 2: The 30/60/90 Check-in (90 min)

Intent — Book 3 lightweight check-ins.

"30-min video call at 30, 60, 90 days post-exit. Optional attendance for us."

Materials — Calendar.

Debrief — Log what changed.

Exercise 3: The Second-Chair Certificate (30 min)

Intent — Every owner gets one.

"Signed certificate: role, ecosystem, dates, handoff artifact."

Materials — Template + print.

Debrief — Ceremony includes handing them out.

Journey signals, this state

- Narrative — The story: we left on the date we promised.
- Cognitive — The model: exit = ceremony + check-ins + certification.
- Identity — I am someone who leaves cleanly.

Roadmap

Step	When	State	Outcome
Week 1 — Owners	40h	Love	Handoff contracts signed.
Weeks 2-3 — Rituals	80h	Magic	Ritual retirement doc.
Weeks 4-5 — Governance	80h	Calm	Constitution shipped.
Weeks 6-10 — Silent build	200h	Open	Break-fix log + team-led retro.
Weeks 11-12 — Exit	80h	Free	Exit ceremony + certificates.

Commitment contract

What does the ecosystem look like when we're gone?

On _____ the ecosystem will be owned by _____. Its constitution is _____.

The 30/60/90 check-ins are booked for _____. The retirement clause triggers when _____.

Witness — The named steward of the ecosystem.

Appendix — Printable prompt cards

Love — Why this matters

Facilitator: "Open a door — never a slide deck."

Magic — The reframe

Facilitator: "Show the thing they didn't know was there."

Calm — Organize complexity

Facilitator: "Draw the map slowly. Name each region once."

Open — Pattern discovery

Facilitator: "Get out of the way. Notice, don't teach."

Free — Commitment

Facilitator: "Ask for the smallest brave promise."